United Kingdom Liaison Mission in Japan,

TOKYO. 132

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(1030/65/52) 18th February, 1952.

FJ 10310/54

Dear R.S.,

I said that I was not going to write any more about the Yoshida letter, but I spoke too soon, as you will see from the enclosed memorandum by George Clutton recounting a conversation which he had with the Prime Minister after a private farewell dinner to which Mr. Yoshida had invited him.

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When I carried out the instructions in your telegram No. 126 of the 8th February I did not use the precise form of words indicated in my telegram No. 169 of the 5th February because more than a week had elapsed since Mr. Yoshida made his alleged remarks in a Diet committee. In the circumstances I thought it better merely to say that the Secretary of State had asked me to bring to his attention the replies he had given in the House of Commons, and I added the relevant extract from Mr. Eden's speech in the Foreign Affairs Debate on 5th February. You will see that these extracts got right under Mr. Yoshida's skin, and it does appear that, however foolishly, up to then he really believed that we condoned his action. Perhaps it would have been better after all if I had delivered the message which the Secretary of State discussed with Mr. Acheson at the time, though it would not, of course, have altered the position, and Mr. Yoshida is no longer in any doubt as to our attitude. George Clutton does not think that the Prime Minister would have told him a deliberate lie, and if that is so it does look as if the Americans had given him to understand that we had withdrawn our opposition.

Clearly the Japanese are very upset, and I think that is a good thing. Mr. Iguchi told me last night that they intended to reply to my letter to the Prime Minister, and I asked him what they intended to say. Iguchi then entered into a long explanation to convince me that the Japanese Government had no intention of extending to Chiang Kai-shek any recognition beyond his de facto control of Formosa and the Pescadores. I said I should be interested to know how they thought they could do this, quite apart from the fact of whether it would be acceptable to Chiang Kai-shek. Iguchi, who is rather a silly man, said that they would find a formula, to which I retorted that we had considered this problem ourselves and could not conceive of a formula which would limit the degree of Japan's

R.H. Scott, Esq., C.M.G., C.B.E.,
Foreign Office.

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Japan's recognition and not prejudice her position with the mainland of China. He then drew into the conversation Mr. Nishimura, who is one of the best draughtsmen in the Gaimusho, but the latter was more cautious and admitted that he did not know what the formula could be. In the course of this conversation I reminded Iguchi that Mr. Yoshida's letter did not refer only to the territory that Chiang Kai-shek controls now but also to any territory he might control hereafter. He did not seem to have grasped that it might have wider implications.

All this leads me to wonder whether the Japanese have any very serious intention of carrying out their undertakings in the Yoshida letter, and whether they will not eventually sabotage the proceedings by proposing a formula which the Nationalists cannot possibly accept. It also seems clear that they have failed to appreciate the significance of the terms which Yoshida employed in his letter and which, I have always believed, were dictated by Dulles.

From the point of view of Anglo-Japanese relations, I think all this may have done some good. For I believe that at the present time and under Yoshida's leadership the Japanese are genuinely anxious to have good relations with us, and that they are really upset to discover that, in bowing to American dictation, they have not treated us very well. I am glad George Clutton made the point that good relations between the United States and Japan are a cardinal point in British policy, the more so as I doubt whether the Japanese believe it. We cannot therefore rub this in too often. It may be that, as a result of my letter and George's conversation with the Prime Minister, the latter may be a little more disposed in future to take counsel with us, and if that happens it will be a good thing.

I am sending a copy of this letter to Washington.

Yours ever,

Bill Hayter

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